



## September 2026 Newsletter

Welcome back to another exciting and invigorating semester!

For those of you who are unfamiliar with the Critical Humanities Commons, it is located at the Faculty of Humanities, in Clearihue Building C305. The Commons is run by myself--Dr. Jaipreet Viridi, Director--and Sarah Lawrence, the talented Administrative Assistant.

We have two rooms available for booking events:

1. **Commons Hub:** a multimodal space accommodating up to 50 people, equipped with accessible meeting technology, including ceiling-mounted microphones, an 180-degree camera, and whiteboard screen. This is where our primary events are hosted. Seating can be reconfigured to match event needs as required.
2. **Commons Lounge:** a welcoming collective area designed for informal social gatherings, open dialogue, and interdisciplinary exchange. The Lounge is a flexible, inclusive space where faculty, students, and visitors can meet causally, host drop-in conversations, or engage in spontaneous

collaborations for teaching, research, creative, or community. Event receptions are usually held here.

If you have an event in mind and you'll like to discuss space use, please use our [booking form](#) and we'll contact you for further details.

Check out our slate of exciting programming for the month below, including our flagship *Critical Encounters* speaker series.

All the best for adventures ahead,

Jaipreet Virdi

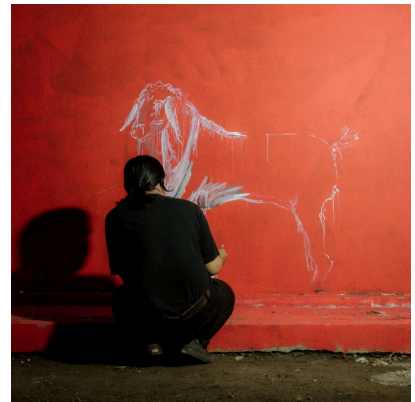
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## September Events at the Commons

**SEPT 15, 2:30-4:30pm**

**Artistic Practice, Community & Solidarity:  
Reflections from Yogyakarta to Victoria**

Pacific and Asian Studies Lansdowne Lecture  
**Critical Humanities Commons & Zoom**



[Learn More](#)

Drawing on over two decades of collective artistic and community work in Indonesia, and their collaborative work with UVic's Legacy Galleries, artists Bayu Widodo and Patub Porx will reflect critically on developing spaces for sustainable arts-focused community, meaningful critique and social engagement. Their Lansdowne lecture will use audio-visual materials to examine artistic practice as not merely a form of expression but as a way of bringing people together, testing new forms of collaboration and forging solidarity amid social fragmentation and rising authoritarianism. Avoiding the common tendency to romanticize community, their talk will explore its tensions and demands, and what it takes to maintain independent spaces amid political pressure. With an eye to the future, Porx and Widodo ask how collective artistic work might enable new forms of public life.

After the lecture, attendees are invited to the opening of the wara-wara exhibit at the Legacy Art Gallery, 630 Yates Street.

**SEPT 17, 10-11am**

**Manila Bayou: Louisiana Filipinos and the Birth of Asian America**

Asian North American Feminisms Speaker Series  
**Online Event**



[Learn More](#)

Join us in this virtual speaker series featuring Asian North American feminist scholars, critique, and activism. The first speaker for this series is **Michael Salgarolo** (Bard College).

In the mid-nineteenth century, Filipino sailors deserted ships in the port of New Orleans and built a renegade fishing settlement in the Louisiana marshlands. Their village, St. Malo, was one of the earliest Asian communities in the United States, and has long been recognized as an important milestone in Asian American history. In this talk story, Dr. Michael Menor Salgarolo will reveal how he has used archival research and historical imagination to tell the story of these sailors and their descendants as they built a subversive community in the Louisiana bayous and navigated shifting landscapes of race, gender, and empire in the Jim Crow South.

**SEPT 25, 7pm**

***Marco, la verdad inventada (Marco, the Invented Truth)***

16th Latin American and Spanish Film Week, organized by The Hispanic Film Society of Victoria  
**Cinecenta**



[Learn More](#)

Based on true events. *Marco* explores the story of a concentration camp deportee who never existed. For years, Enric Marco, a charismatic man, was able to maintain, both in public opinion and in the view of his own family, a deeply complex lie: that he had been a prisoner in a nazi concentration camp. A man who rose to the presidency of the Spanish Association of Holocaust victims, Marco became a prominent figure for his supposed bravery and suffering until one day a journalist discovered that his survival story was, in fact, a fabrication.

**SEPT 28, 2:30-3:30pm**

Immediate Response Required: Speaking and Writing on Current Events

Talks & Tours Public History Series  
**Critical Humanities Commons**



[Learn More](#)

Public History is the practice of applying historical research and methods to an audience outside of the university. Museums, libraries, heritage sites all use history to make the past accessible and relevant for us.

*Talks & Tours* is a speaker series offering scholars ways to deepen their engagement with Public History and learn from exceptional professionals and institutions. The first speaker of this series is Dr. Jaipreet Virdi, who will share her experiences engaging with public media -- radio, newspaper, podcasts -- on breaking news in technology, medicine, and disability.

All are welcome to join, learn, and be inspired!

**SEPT 29, 3:00-4:30**

CATALYST: Meet Our New HUMS Faculty

*Critical Encounters Speaker Series*  
**Critical Humanities Commons & Zoom**



[Learn More](#)

Join us for the first event of the *Critical Humanities* speaker series! Learn about the work our new Humanities faculty are doing and stay for the reception to follow.

Featured speakers:

Gabriel Quigley (English)

Jules Gill-Peterson (History)

Steve Accardi (Arts & Technical Writing Program)

Jenne Schmidt (Gender Studies)

Janet Downie (Greek & Roman Studies)

Kadji Amin (Gender Studies)

speaker series

# CRITICAL ENCOUNTERS

2026-2027 program

*Critical Encounters* is a free monthly speaker series hosted by the Critical Humanities Commons dedicated to exploring how humanistic thinking can illuminate, challenge, and shape the world within and beyond the academy.

All events are hybrid and in Clearihue C305 3:00-4:30pm unless otherwise noted.

**Sept 29**

**CATALYST**

*Meet Our New Humanities Faculty*

**Oct 27**

**RACHEL ZELLARS**

Saint Mary's University

*The Signals of Authoritarianism and Anti-Blackness in the Canadian Landscape*

**Nov 3**

**LEXI GIIZHIGOKWE  
NAHWEJIIZHIC & ELIZA  
CHANDLER**

INDIGENOUS DISABILITY AWARENESS

*MONTH: A Conversation on Neurodiversity*

**Jan 26**

**JOANNE LEOW**

Simon Fraser University

*BOOK TALK: Exhumations: Inside the Body of a Petrostate*

**Feb 2**

**KRISTEN SCHILT &  
JULES GILL-PETERSON**

University of Chicago / University of Victoria

*HUMANITIES WEEK: A Conversation on Gender, Trans Lives, and Identity*

**Feb 9**

**EMMANUEL DELILLE**

Nagoya University

*Toward a Global History of the "Ethno-Sciences" in Canada*

**Mar 30**

**QUILL R KUKLA**

Georgetown University

*LANSDOWNE LECTURE: Agency, Finitude, and Leaving Well*  
David Strong Building C103





We acknowledge and respect the Lək'wəḡən (Songhees and X̱sepsəm/Esquimalt) Peoples on whose territory the university stands, and the Lək'wəḡən and W̱SÁNEĆ Peoples whose historical relationships with the land continue to this day.

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